



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Ireland. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background—being bilingual and culturally connected to both Denmark and Ireland gives you a strong foundation. Since you've just finished primary school (in Denmark that usually means **Folkeskole** up to 9th or 10th grade), your next step typically falls into one of a few main paths, depending on your interests and goals.

Here are your main options after Folkeskole:

1. Gymnasium (STX, HHX, HTX, HF) – for Academic Pathways

If you're interested in university later on, this is usually the way to go.

- **STX (Almen Gymnasium):** Broad academic focus – good if you enjoy subjects like history, languages, science, etc.
- **HHX:** Focus on business, economics, and marketing – great for careers in business or entrepreneurship.
- **HTX:** Focus on technology, science, and innovation – ideal if you're into engineering, programming, or design.
- **HF (2-year):** More practical and less academically intense – good if you want a faster route to certain professions or university college.

✓ **Good if:** You're unsure but want to keep doors open for university studies (in Denmark or abroad).

2. EUD/EGU/Erhvervsuddannelse – for Vocational Training

This leads directly to a profession (e.g., electrician, carpenter, hairdresser, chef).

✓ **Good if:** You like hands-on work and want to start earning or working sooner.

🔧 **Note:** Some vocational schools offer combined programmes where you can also take subjects that qualify you for higher education later (EUX).

3. International or IB Programs

Denmark offers **International Baccalaureate (IB)** programs, which are taught in English and recognized worldwide—including in Ireland.

✓ **Good if:** You're considering university abroad, want education in English, or feel more connected to international environments.

4. Efterskole (optional year)

Many Danish students take an extra year at an **efterskole** after 9th or 10th grade to grow personally, explore interests (sports, music, outdoor life, etc.), and prepare for upper secondary school.

✓ **Good if:** You're not sure what you want yet, or want a unique social and learning experience.

Choosing What's Best for You:

Ask yourself:

- **Do I want to go to university?** → Choose a gymnasium (STX, HHX, HTX, HF, or IB).
 - **Do I want to start working/training soon?** → Look at vocational (EUD/EUX) paths.
 - **Do I want to explore or take a break to think more?** → Consider efterskole.
 - **Am I interested in studying in English or going abroad later?** → IB or international programs could be ideal.
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As an Irish citizen living in Denmark:

You can **study in both Denmark and Ireland tuition-free** at most levels because of EU rules. So in the future, you'll have the **option to apply to Irish universities** (e.g., Trinity College Dublin or UCD) if you meet the academic entry requirements.

Would you like help narrowing it down based on your interests (e.g., science, arts, business, tech, etc.)? That could make the recommendation even more personal.